SEMINAR 1

History of AI

2nd of April 2025

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Outline of the course

- Lectures & book: exam material (both are important)
- Types of sessions:
  - Lectures
  - Lecture recap
  - Book recap & working on assignment
  - Assignment feedback
- Assignment bonus: [av. of 4 best out of 6] > 6 → you can skip a designated question on the exam
- Exam = 100% of final grade
- Lectures, seminars and assignments aren't mandatory – but recommended!

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Week 1	31/3 **13:30 – 15:15** **MF-FG2** Lecture 1 (reading: none)	1/4 **17:30-18.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	2/4 **09:00-10:45** **HG-14A36** Book recap & working on assignment **11:00** Assignment 1 **13:30-14:15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap **14:30-15.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	3/4 **15:30-16:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **16:30-17:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **17:30-18:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **18:30-19:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback	4/4
Week 2	7/4 **13:30 – 15:15** **MF-FG2** Lecture 2 (reading: Ch. 4 and 5)	8/4 **17:30-18.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	9/4 **09:00-10:45** **HG-14A36** Book recap & working on assignment **11:00** Assignment 2 **13:30-14:15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap **14:30-15.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	10/4 **15:30-16:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **16:30-17:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **17:30-18:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **18:30-19:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback	11/4
Week 3	14/4 **13:30 – 15:15** **MF-FG2** Lecture 3 (reading: Ch. 6 and 7)	15/4 **17:30-18.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	16/4 **09:00-10:45** **HG-14A36** Book recap & working on assignment **11:00** Assignment 3 **13:30-14:15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap **14:30-15.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	17/4 **15:30-16:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **16:30-17:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **17:30-18:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **18:30-19:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback	18/4
Week 4	21/4 *Easter Monday: lecture moved to Wednesday.*	22/4 *Lecture recap moved to Thursday.*	23/4 **09:00-10:45** **HG-14A36** Book recap & working on assignment **11:00** Assignment 4 **11:00 – 12:45** **HG-14A00** Lecture 4 (reading: Ch. 8 and 9) **13:30-14:15**	24/4 **11:00-11.45** **NU-2B01, NU-2B11** Lecture recap **15:30-16:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **16:30-17:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **17:30-18:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11**	25/4

			HG-0G28, HG-0G30 Lecture recap **14:30-15.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	Assignment feedback **18:30-19:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback	
May holiday	28/4	29/4	30/4	1/5	2/5
Week 5	5/4 *Fifth of May: lecture moved to Wednesday.*	6/4 *Lecture recap moved to Thursday.*	7/4 **09:00-10:45** **HG-14A36** Book recap & working on assignment **11:00** Assignment 5 **11:00 – 12:45** **HG-14A00** Lecture 5 (reading: Ch. 10 and 11) **13:30-14:15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap **14:30-15.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	8/4 **11:00-11.45** **NU-2B01, NU-2B11** Lecture recap **15:30-16:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **16:30-17:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **17:30-18:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **18:30-19:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback	9/4
Week 6	12/5 **13:30 – 15:15** **MF-FG2** Lecture 6 (reading: Ch. 12 and 13)	13/5 **17:30-18.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	14/5 **09:00-10:45** **HG-14A36** Book recap & working on assignment **11:00** Assignment 6 **13:30-14:15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap **14:30-15.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	15/5 **15:30-16:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **16:30-17:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **17:30-18:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback **18:30-19:15** **NU-4B05, NU-4B11** Assignment feedback	16/5
Week 7	19/5 **13:30 – 15:15** **MF-FG2** Lecture 7 (reading: Ch. 14 and 15)	20/5 **17:30-18.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	21/5 **09:00-10:45** **HG-14A36** Book recap & exam practice **13:30-14:15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap **14:30-15.15** **HG-0G28, HG-0G30** Lecture recap	22/5 **08:30 – 10:45/11:15** **SCVU-1 1/2/3/4/5/6/7/8** Exam	23/5
Week 8	26/5	27/5	28/5	29/5	30/5

Outline of this seminar

- Outline of the course ✓
- Getting to know each other
- How to read?
- Book presentations
- Break
- Answering every part of the question
- Writing essays: basic structure
- Working on assignment 1

➢ At the end of this session, you'll know how to write essays and use your knowledge to answer exam questions!

Getting to know each other

- Introduce yourself: name and a fun fact

How to read?

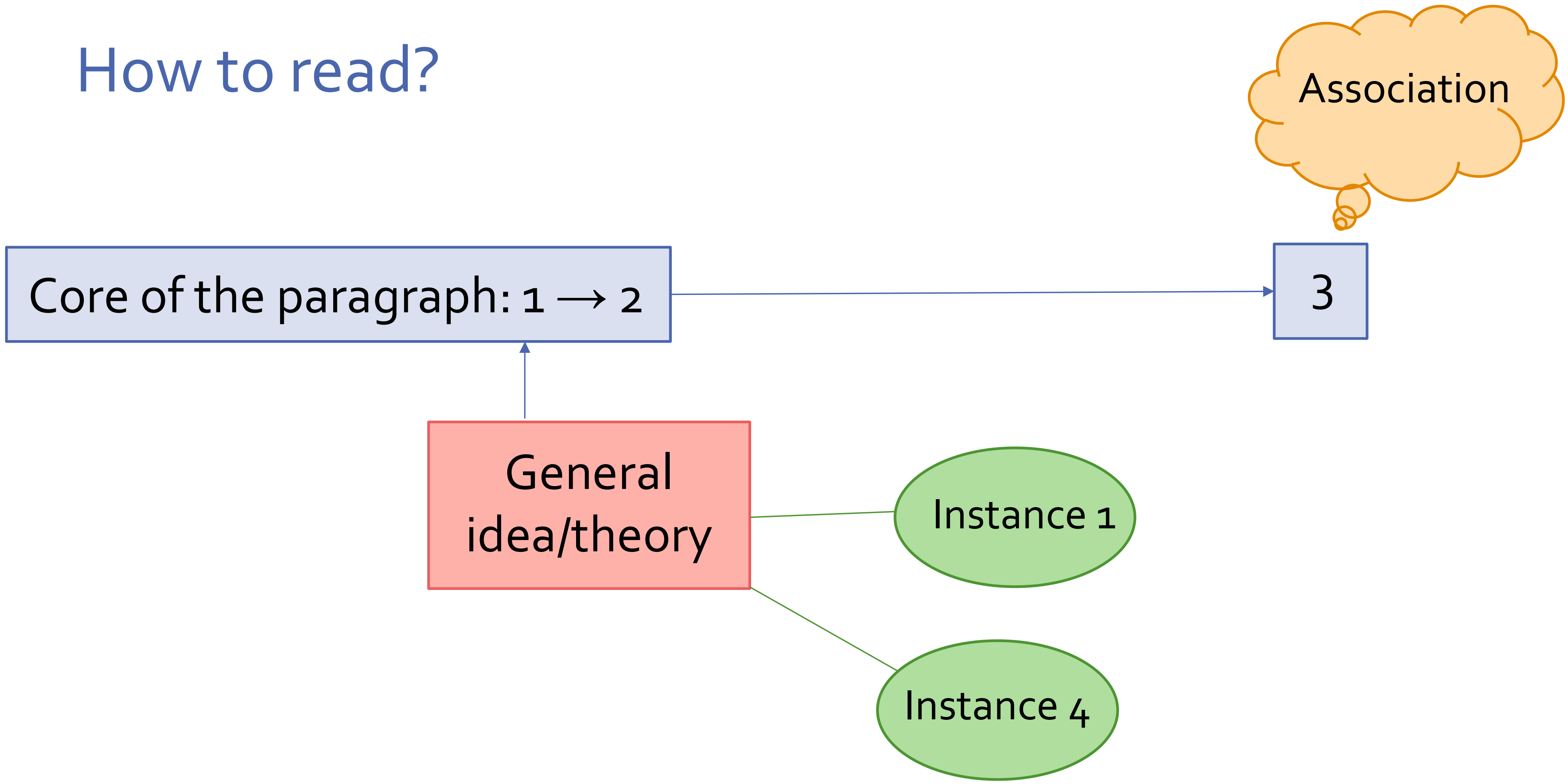
- What are strategies to read effectively?

  - Finding core sentences
  - Finding examples in the text
  - Writing down associations/questions that pop up

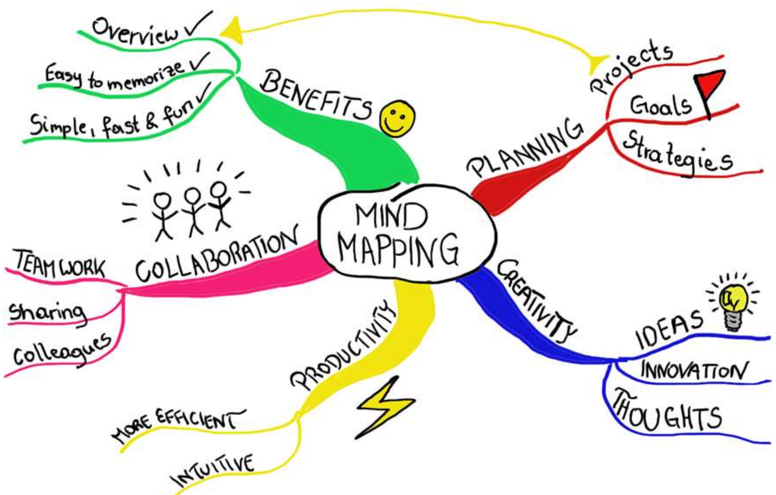
  Making a summary/mind map

  - Avoid passive strategies
    - Marking < writing down
    - Typing < writing by hand
    - Copying < paraphrasing
    - Just writing < mind mapping

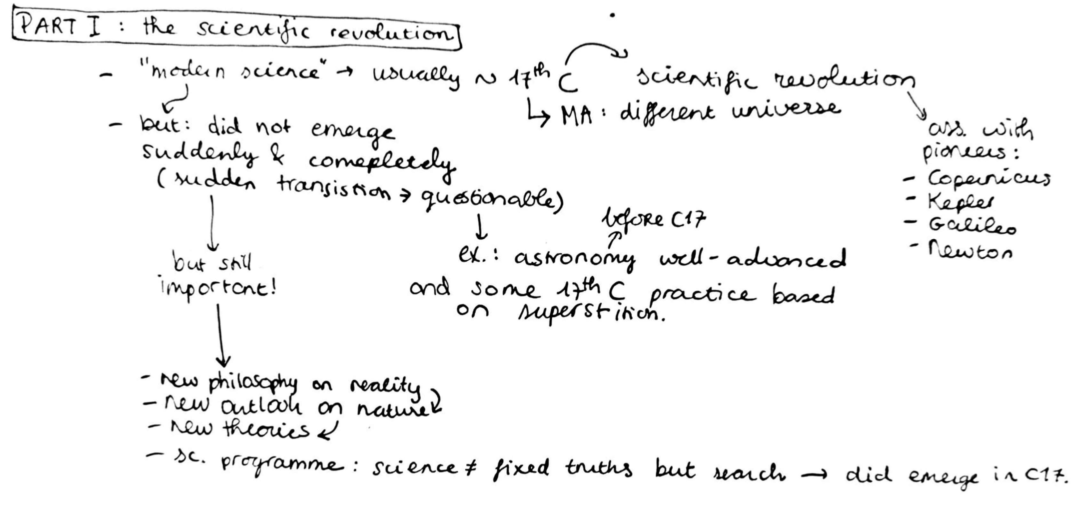
How to read?


Association
Core of the paragraph: 1 → 2
3
General idea/theory
Instance 1
Instance 4

How to read?



MIND MAPPING
BENEFITS
Overview ✓
Easy to memorize ✓
Simple, fast & fun ✓
PLANNING
Projects
Goals
Strategies
COLLABORATION
TEAMWORK
Sharing
Colleagues
PRODUCTIVITY
MORE EFFICIENT
INTUITIVE
CREATIVITY
IDEAS
INNOVATION
THOUGHTS



PART I : the scientific revolution
- "modern science" → usually ~ 17th C scientific revolution
↳ MA : different universe
ass. with pioneers:
- Copernicus
- Kepler
- Galileo
- Newton
- but: did not emerge suddenly & completely
(sudden transistion → questionable)
but still important!
before C17
ex.: astronomy well-advanced and some 17th C practice based on superstition.
- new philosophy on reality
- new outlook on nature
- new theories
- sc. programme : science ≠ fixed truths but search → did emerge in C17.

Book presentations

- Short recap, every week, around 20 min. per chapter
- Choose your chapter: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1ZUjx4bNxDGvooFvhaXsEaoOZ-3g-ieGx5y5lu2rdYao/edit?usp=sharing
- If you can't make it (for a good reason), let me know beforehand!

BREAK

Answering every part of the question

ENIAC (1946) is in the book picked as the starting point of a history of computing. At the same time, this starting point is discussed. Explain why this machine is an obvious starting point and mention an alternative - with arguments why it could count as an alternative, and why it was passed by.

a) ENIAC is an obvious starting point because…

b) An alternative starting point would be…

c) It counts as an alternative because…

d) It was passed by because…

→ Not very creative, much to improve. But good starting point!

Writing essays: basic structure

- What is an essay?
  - Statement (thesis)/question → narrative

    (here, the "thesis" is defined by the exam question)
  - Structure: intro, body, conclusion
  - In this case: 200 words min.

- Intro
  - Tell what the reader can expect in the following text
  - Perhaps one sentence summarizing your content
  - Advanced: a question, anecdote or statistic
- Body
  - The actual content
- Conclusion
  - Summary, repeating of the question/statement if present
  - Advanced: follow-up question

Answering every part of the question

ENIAC (1946) is in the book picked as the starting point of a history of computing. At the same time, this starting point is discussed. Explain why this machine is an obvious starting point and mention an alternative - with arguments why it could count as an alternative, and why it was passed by.

a) ENIAC is an obvious starting point because…
b) An alternative starting point would be…
c) It counts as an alternative because…
d) It was passed by because…

Body

→ Not very creative, much to improve. But good starting point!

Assignment 1: Histories of computing

The "prehistory" of computing cannot be understood as one history. Several histories, sometimes (but hardly) intersecting, have to be taken into account to understand where the computer actually had its origins. Explain this statement.

a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?

b) Did you answer all the questions?

c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

Assignment 1: History of AI

In the lecture, it was suggested that history of AI is older than history of computing. Explain the line of thought.

a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?

b) Did you answer all the questions?

c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

Assignment 1: Artificial language

During the early 20th century various artificial languages were developed, all from rather different perspectives. Give two examples and explain their relevance in the history of AI.

a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?
b) Did you answer all the questions?
c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

Assignment 1: Digital culture

During the course the notion of digital culture was introduced as a defining characteristic of modern culture. Give an example from your own profession or experience where digital culture is fitting to describe the change in an existing habit. Explain how (or in what way) computer technology actually changed the situation. Discuss the positive and negative implications of this change.

a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?

b) Did you answer all the questions?

c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

Closing remarks

- Summaries are a tool to read more attentively - in essence, we want you to read attentively and reflect critically on the texts :)
- Although repeating the question provides an answer that is correct content-wise, and is thus a good starting point, it can lead to “boring” essays. Feel free to get more creative!

Heads-up

- Coming week:
  - Lecture on Monday (prepare by reading Ch. 4 and 5, prepare a few slides if you're up to present)
  - Lecture recap on Tuesday / Wednesday
  - Book recap/assignment seminar on Wednesday
  - Assignment feedback on Thursday
  - Next Wednesday we'll discuss more essay writing techniques and practice with assignment 2

QUESTIONS?

See you next week!